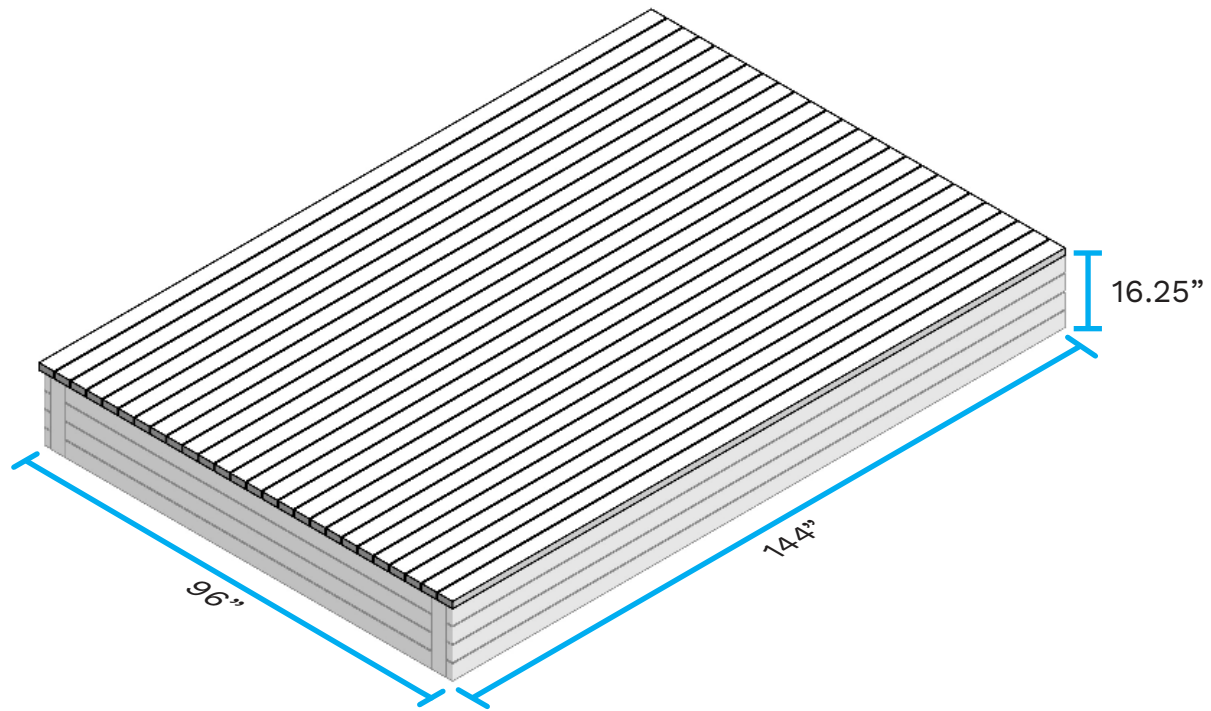




STAGE

ASSEMBLY INSTRUCTIONS

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

1. This document includes recommendations for do-it-yourself (DIY) construction of a [stage](#). As a DIY project, the Owner, or the Owner's Contractor, is required to procure, fabricate, assemble, install, and maintain all project materials. These are recommendations only and any material, assembly, and construction must be tailored to specific project requirements.
2. These recommendations are based on common best practices associated with standard DIY home-improvement and/or landscape construction. These best practices may include working knowledge and experience with manual and power tools, hardware, fasteners, lumber, concrete footings, and associated techniques of assembly and construction. Prior working knowledge of these best practices is required so as to avoid harm or personal injury to self or others, or to property.
3. This document includes recommendations for the sequence and assembly of [stage](#) components. Locate your [stages](#) in your plan you created in the 'Dream' workbook to find the proposed location and dimension of all [stages](#). This plan must be tailored to the specific conditions of the project site, including property lines, existing features- such as walls, trees, etc- and any other existing site conditions that may limit or otherwise influence the installation. Use your cost estimation spreadsheet to determine the quantity needed for all your [stages](#).
4. Before using any power equipment (such as drills, saws, augers, or other), review all manufacturer safety requirements. While handling or operating any power equipment, follow all manufacturer safety requirements. Do not allow others who have not reviewed and/or follow manufacturer safety requirements to handle or utilize power equipment.
5. The owner is solely responsible for any work required to secure, and comply with, all necessary building and safety codes, permits, and regulatory approvals.
6. These recommendations assume that the project site has been sufficiently prepared for construction. This includes, but is not limited to: identification of utilities that may interfere or otherwise impact installation; the removal of trash, hazards, unwanted structures; or other conditions that may inhibit safe construction.
7. Before construction, review the project site conditions to identify any potential limitations to assembly and installation. This includes determining advance notification by the Owner of utility companies so as to determine the location of all above and below ground utilities.
8. All persons associated with building and construction should sign a volunteer waiver.

LEGAL NOTICE:

The recommendations included herein are based on standard practices of fabrication and construction of garden furnishings. In no event shall Thomas Jefferson University (TJU), TJU's Lab For Social Innovation, Park-in-a-Truck, and/or its faculty, staff or affiliates be liable for any damages or injury to person or property damages arising out of the use of these recommendations. Thomas Jefferson University (TJU), TJU's Lab For Social Innovation, Park-in-a-Truck, or its faculty, staff and/or affiliates make no warranties, expressed or implied, and hereby disclaims and negates all other warranties, including without limitation, implied warranties or conditions of merchantability, fitness for a particular purpose, or non-infringement of intellectual property or other violation of rights. Further, Thomas Jefferson University (TJU), TJU's Lab For Social Innovation, Park-in-a-Truck, and/or its faculty, staff or affiliates do not warrant or make any representations concerning the accuracy, likely results, or reliability of the use of these recommendations. The use of these recommendations constitutes your acknowledgment of the aforementioned.

STAGE

ASSEMBLY INSTRUCTIONS

COMMON LUMBER SELECTIONS \

WESTERN RED CEDAR:

PRO: NATURALLY WEATHER/ROT RESISTANT LUMBER WITH AESTHETICALLY PLEASING RED TONES AND PLEASANT AROMAS, THAT IS EASY TO WORK WITH. NO PRESERVATION TREATMENTS ARE NECESSARY AS THE SURFACES WILL GRADUALLY DEVELOP A LOVELY GRAY PATINA. IT IS EASILY RECYCLABLE AT THE END OF ITS PRIMARY USE.

CON: COST, BE SURE TO SPECIFY 'KNOTTY' (STK) GRADE WHICH IS MUCH MORE AFFORDABLE THAN 'CLEAR' GRADE.

DOUGLAS FIR:

PRO: MODERATELY WEATHER/ROT RESISTANT AND STRONG LUMBER. IT IS ALSO EASY TO WORK WITH AT A LOWER COST THAN CEDAR. IT IS EASILY RECYCLABLE AT THE END OF ITS PRIMARY USE.

CON: IT WILL NOT STAND THE TEST OF TIME AS WELL AS CEDAR, BUT A GREAT CHOICE ESPECIALLY IF YOU PLAN TO PAINT IT.

PRESSURE TREATED:

PRO: WEATHER/ROT RESISTANT LUMBER AT A LOW COST.

CON: LUMBER IS OFTEN OF VARIABLE POOR QUALITY AND SATURATED WITH CHEMICAL TREATMENT MAKING IT DIFFICULT TO WORK WITH LEADING TO INCONSISTENT RESULTS. NEEDS 1-4 MONTHS OF AIR DRYING BEFORE PAINTING. NOT EASILY RECYCLABLE AND OFTEN ENDS UP IN LANDFILLS AT THE END OF ITS PRIMARY USE. NOT RECOMMENDED FOR USE IN AREAS WHERE VEGETABLES ARE GROWN.

GENERAL NOTES:

1. WHEN ORDERING LARGE QUALITIES, ORDER AT LEAST 5% MORE LUMBER. TO ALLOW FOR SOME VARIABLE LUMBER QUALITY AND INCORRECT CUTS.

2. EXTERIOR WOOD TREATMENT CAN PROLONG THE LIFE OF YOUR PARK ELEMENTS. HOWEVER, IT IS NOT NECESSARY TO BRING MANY YEARS OF ENJOYMENT. ANY TREATMENTS MUST BE APPLIED AND MAINTAINED PROPERLY WHICH IS A LABOR INTENSIVE PROCESS. ONE SHOULD DECIDE IF THIS IS PRACTICAL OR NOT FOR THEIR PARK. THE PARK ELEMENTS ARE LOW COST, DURABLE, AND EASY TO BUILD BY DESIGN AND IT MAY BE MORE PRACTICAL TO SIMPLY HAVE THE NEXT GENERATION REBUILD THE ELEMENTS WHEN DEEMED NECESSARY. BELOW ARE RESOURCES/ LINKS FOR CONSIDERATION IF INTERESTED IN EXTERIOR WOOD TREATMENTS.

<https://www.rockler.com/learn/choosing-the-best-finish-for-outdoor-projects>

<https://www.realmilkpaint.com/blog/tips/best-finish-outdoor-wood/>

<https://vermontnaturalcoatings.com/product-category/exterior/>

STAGE \

TOOLS:

10" OR 12" MITER SAW (or appropriate hand saw)

IMPACT DRIVER for self drilling exterior wood screws

1/4" DRILL BIT

SANDPAPER 120 GRIT

CARPENTERS SQUARE

SAFETY GOOGLES + MASK

MATERIALS:

(588) 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS

LUMBER:

(16) 2" x 4" x 8'

(34) 2" x 4" x 12'

COST

\$300-400\$

1 STEP

1. MARK, LABEL AND CUT LUMBER IN ORDER OF ST-1 TO ST-5 TO THE FOLLOWING LENGTHS:

NOTE: CHECK EACH PIECE OF LUMBER IMPERFECTIONS SUCH AS CRACKS, WARPING, OR UNEVEN MILLING. DISCARD THESE PORTIONS OF LUMBER.

STAGE ASSEMBLY

ST-1: (34) 2 x 4 x **144"**
STAGE FACE & DECK

ST-2: (11) 2 x 4 x **93"**
STAGE FRAME

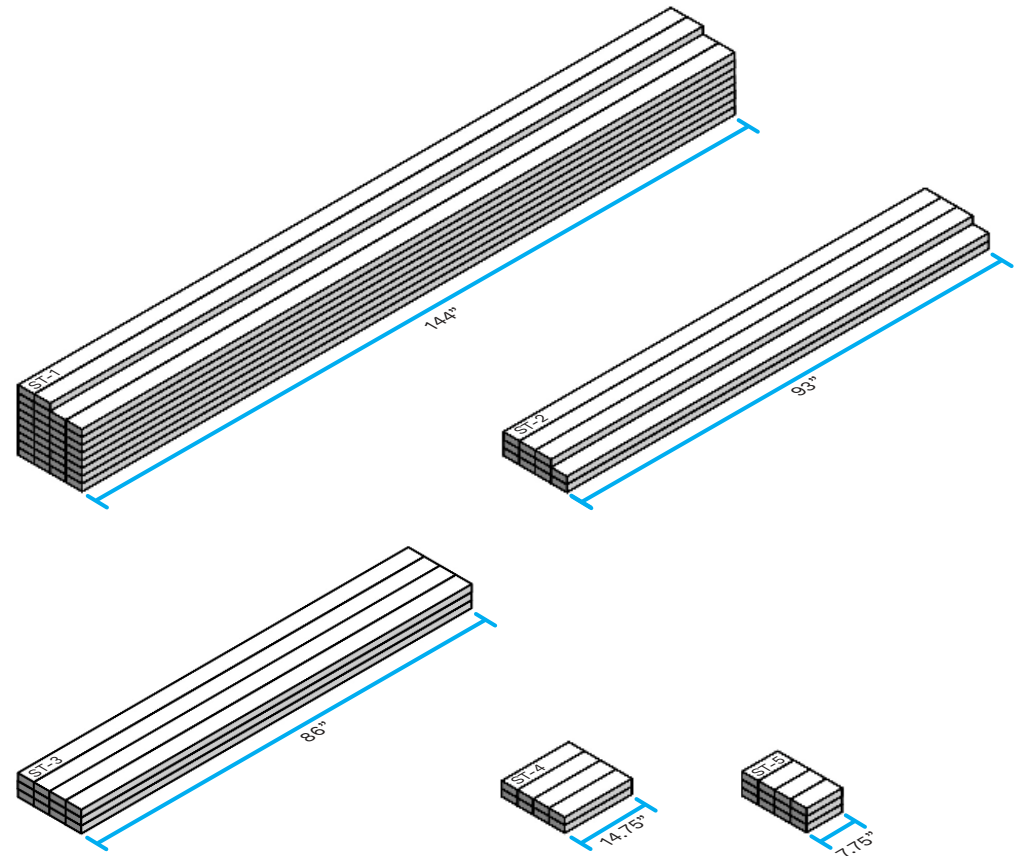
ST-3: (12) 2 x 4 x **86"**
STAGE FRAME

ST-4: (8) 2 x 4 x **14.75"**
STAGE FRAME

ST-5: (12) 2 x 4 x **7.75"**
STAGE FRAME

TIPS:

- LABEL EACH PIECE OF LUMBER AS YOU ARE MEASURING/CUTTING
- HAVE A PILE OF LUMBER FOR ST-1 TO ST-7
- LIGHTLY SANDING CUT EDGES TO REMOVE SPLINTERS WILL ALSO HELP WITH ASSEMBLY.
- IF BUILDING MULTIPLE STAGES, CREATING A STOP FOR YOUR MITER SAW ENSURES ALL PIECES ARE CUT TO THE SAME LENGTH



2 STEP

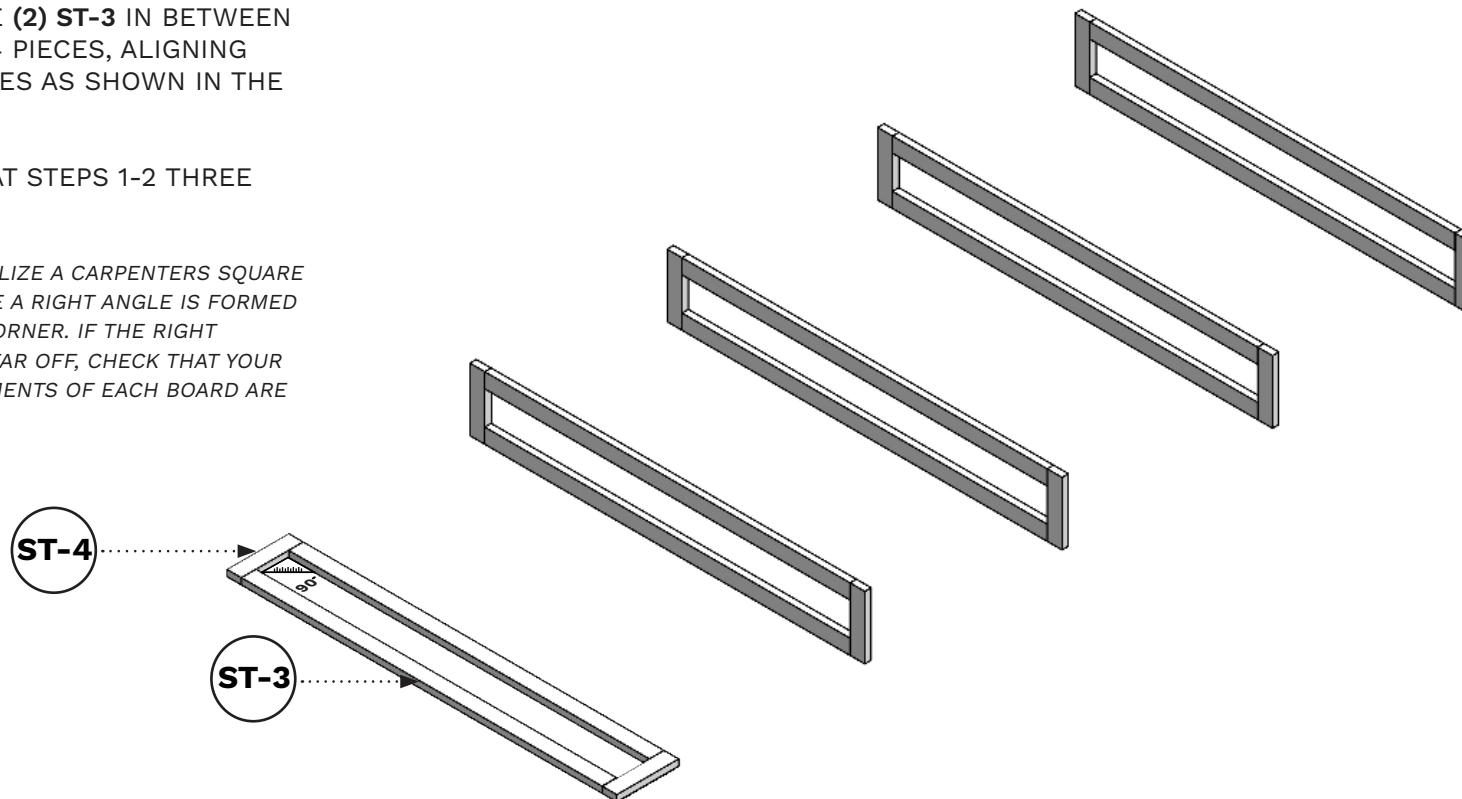
NOTE: THE GRAVEL SURFACE UNDER THE BASE OF THE STAGE SHOULD BE LEVELED AS MUCH AS POSSIBLE BEFORE FINAL PLACEMENT. CONCRETE BLOCKS MAY ALSO BE USED IN LOW AREAS TO LEVEL THE BASE OF THE STAGE.

1. PLACE (2) ST-4 PIECES ON FLAT SURFACE.

2. PLACE (2) ST-3 IN BETWEEN THE ST-4 PIECES, ALIGNING THE EDGES AS SHOWN IN THE IMAGE.

3. REPEAT STEPS 1-2 THREE TIMES.

NOTE: UTILIZE A CARPENTERS SQUARE TO ENSURE A RIGHT ANGLE IS FORMED IN EACH CORNER. IF THE RIGHT ANGLE IS FAR OFF, CHECK THAT YOUR MEASUREMENTS OF EACH BOARD ARE CORRECT.



TIP: BUILDING A 90 DEGREE JIG CAN HELP WITH ASSEMBLY OF THE NEXT TWO STEPS

3 STEP

1. PLACE (2) ST-2 PIECES ON TOP OF THE FRAME CREATED IN STEP TWO.

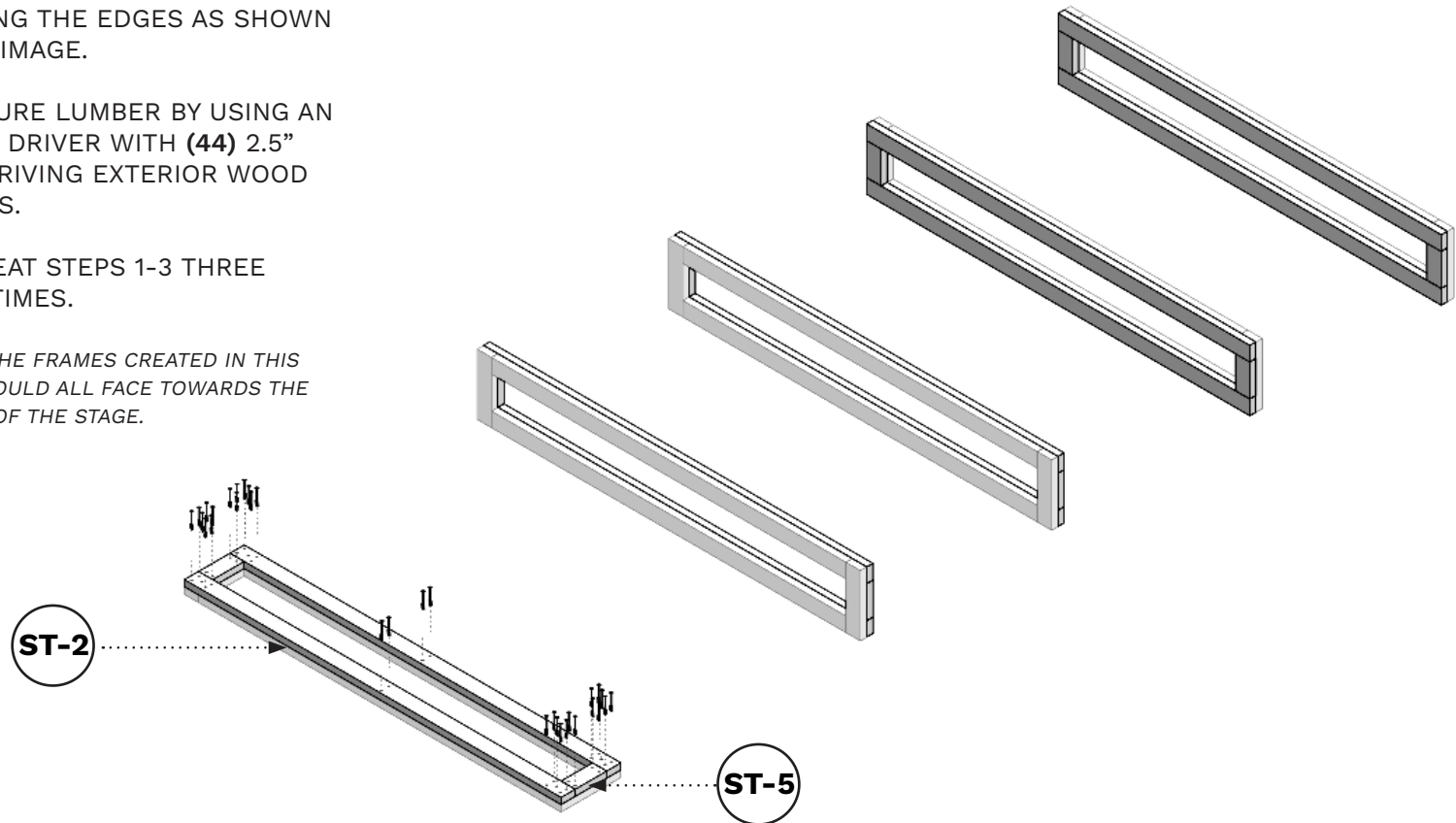
3. USE THE PRE-DRILLING GUIDE  **AT THE END OF THE PACKET TO PRE-DRILL YOUR SCREW HOLES**

3. PLACE (2) ST-5 PIECES IN BETWEEN THE ST-2 PIECES, ALIGNING THE EDGES AS SHOWN IN THE IMAGE.

4. SECURE LUMBER BY USING AN IMPACT DRIVER WITH (44) 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS.

5. REPEAT STEPS 1-3 THREE MORE TIMES.

NOTE: THE FRAMES CREATED IN THIS STEP SHOULD ALL FACE TOWARDS THE MIDDLE OF THE STAGE.



4 STEP

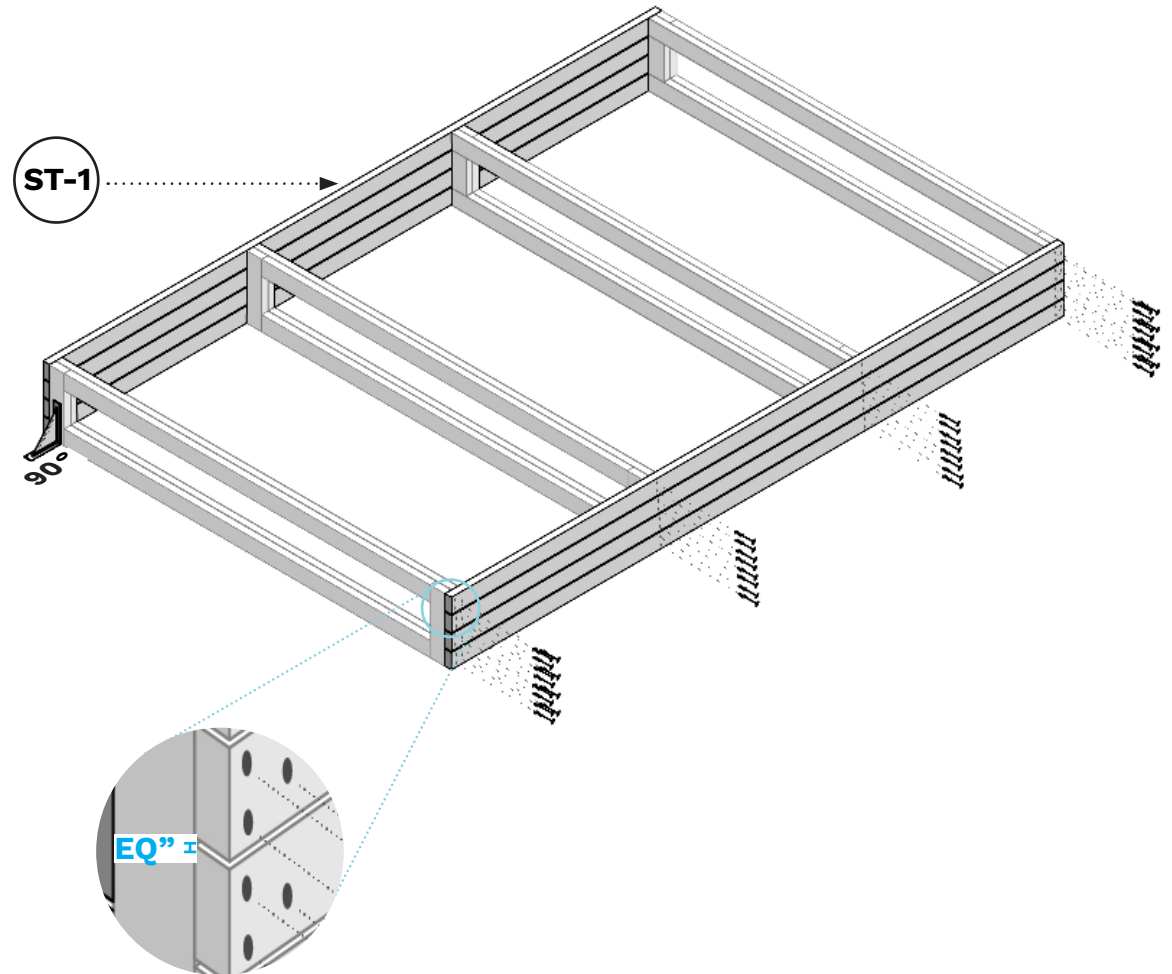
1. STARTING AT THE TOP PLACE (4) ST-1 PIECES ON THE FRONT AND BACK OF THE FRAME CREATED IN STEP THREE. ENSURE LUMBER IS FLUSH WITH TOP AND THERE IS A 1/4" GAP BETWEEN EACH PIECE OF ST-1 LUMBER.

TIP: USE YOUR CARPENTERS SQUARE AS A SPACER.

TIP: ENSURE THE SIDE STAYS 90 DEGREES BY USING A CARPENTERS SQUARE

2. SECURE ST-1 LUMBER BY USING AN IMPACT DRIVER WITH (42) 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS.

3. REPEAT STEP TWO ON THE OTHER SIDE.



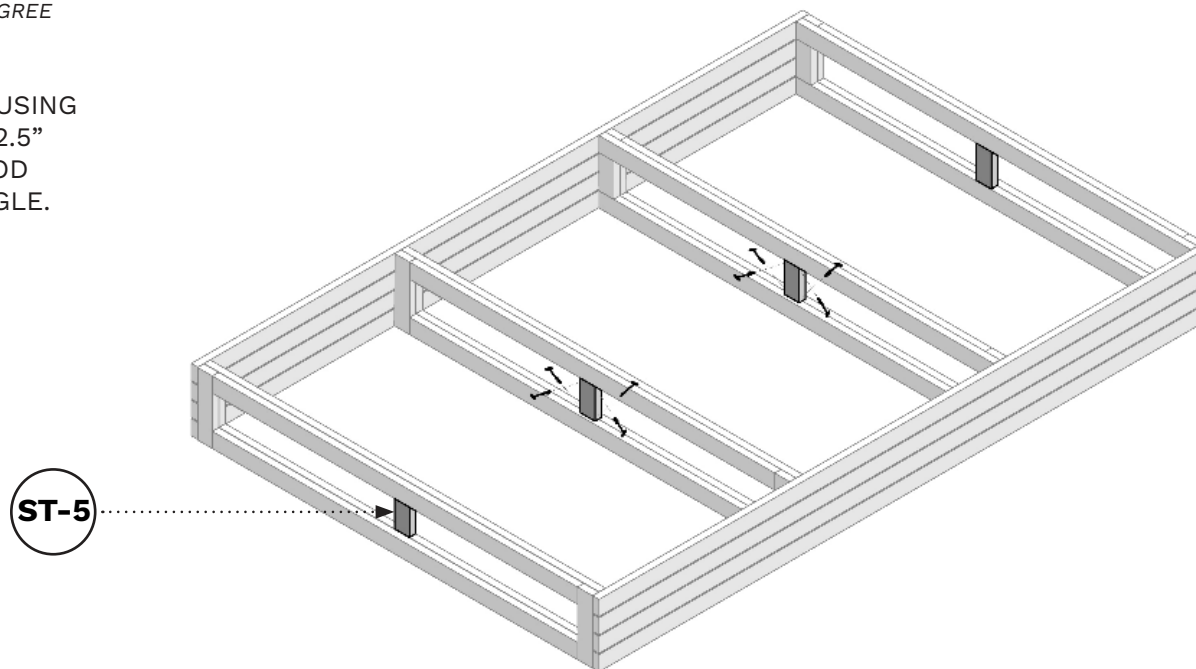
5 STEP

1. PLACE (2) ST-5 PIECES ON THE ENDS IN THE MIDDLE OF THE FRAME CREATED IN STEP THREE.

2. PLACE (2) ST-5 PIECES IN THE MIDDLE OF THE FRAME CREATED FROM STEPS TWO AND THREE.

TIP: PRE-DRILLING WILL HELP WITH INSTALLATION OF SCREWS AT 45 DEGREE ANGLES.

3. SECURE ST-5 LUMBER BY USING AN IMPACT DRIVER WITH (8) 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS AT A 45 DEGREE ANGLE.



6 STEP

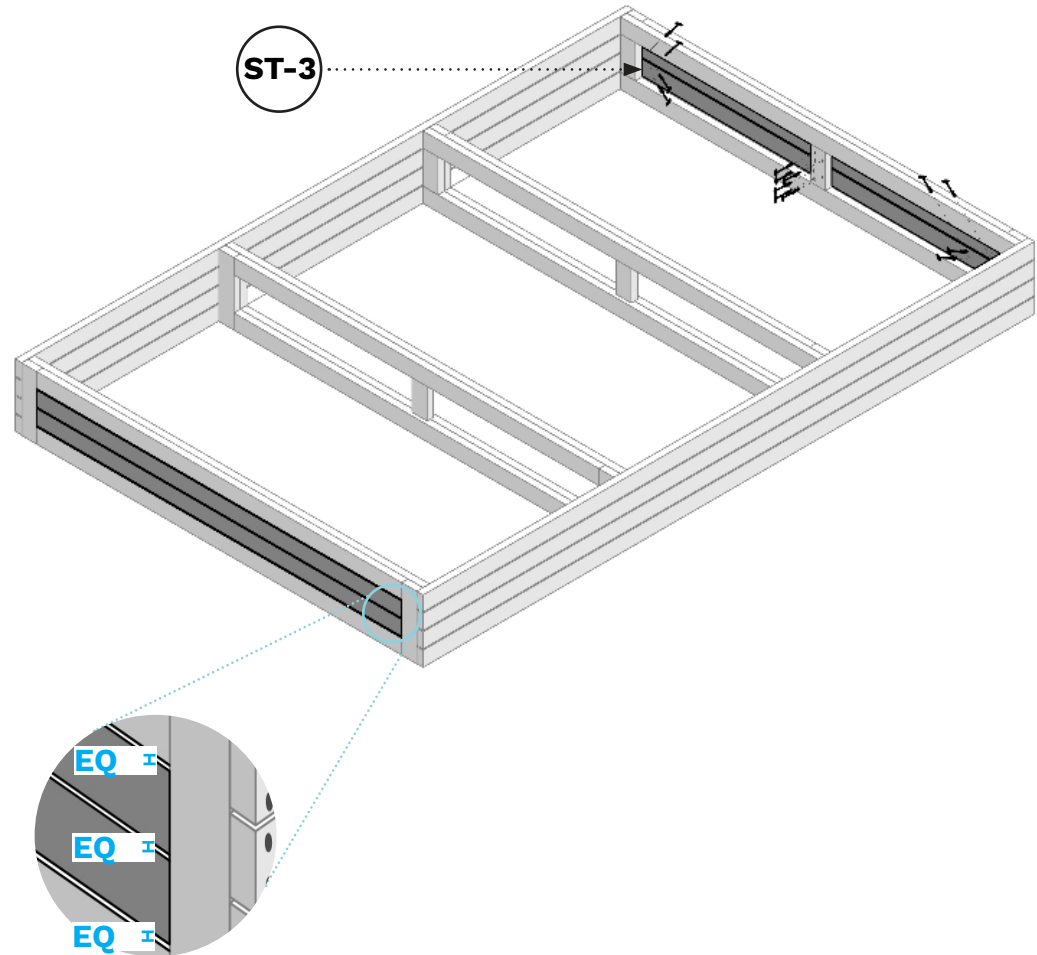
1. PLACE **(2) ST-3** PIECES ON ONE END OF THE FRAME CREATED IN STEP TWO, ENSURE A 1/4" GAP BETWEEN EACH PIECE OF ST-3 LUMBER.

2. SECURE **ST-3** LUMBER FROM THE INSIDE USING AN IMPACT DRIVER WITH **(8)** 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS AT A 45 DEGREE ANGLE.

TIP: PRE-DRILLING WILL HELP WITH INSTALLATION OF SCREWS AT 45 DEGREE

3. USE THE SCREW PATTERN TO SECURE BOARDS TO CENTER ST-5 LUMBER WITH **(6)** 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS

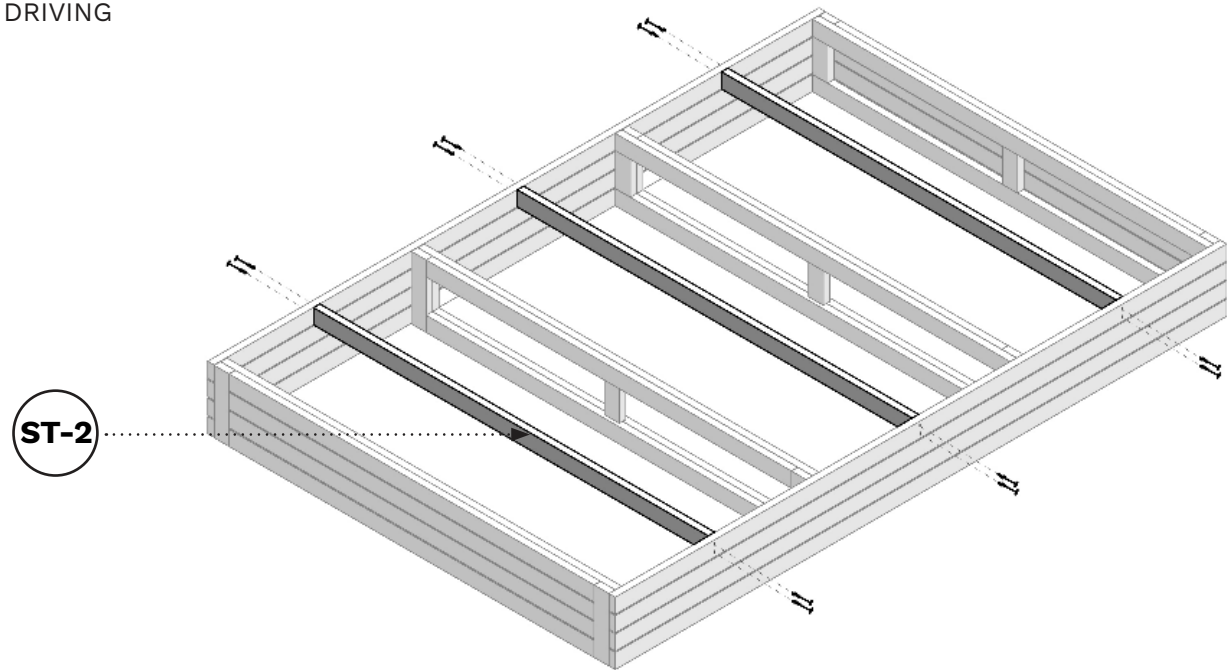
3. REPEAT ON THE OTHER SIDE WITH **(2) ST-3** PIECES



7 STEP

1. PLACE **(3)** **ST-2** PIECES IN BETWEEN THE FOUR FRAME SECTIONS, ENSURE FLUSH WITH THE TOP OF THE ST-1 LUMBER PLACED IN STEP FOUR.

2. SECURE **ST-2** LUMBER INTO THE **ST-1** PIECES BY USING AN IMPACT DRIVER WITH **(12)** 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS.



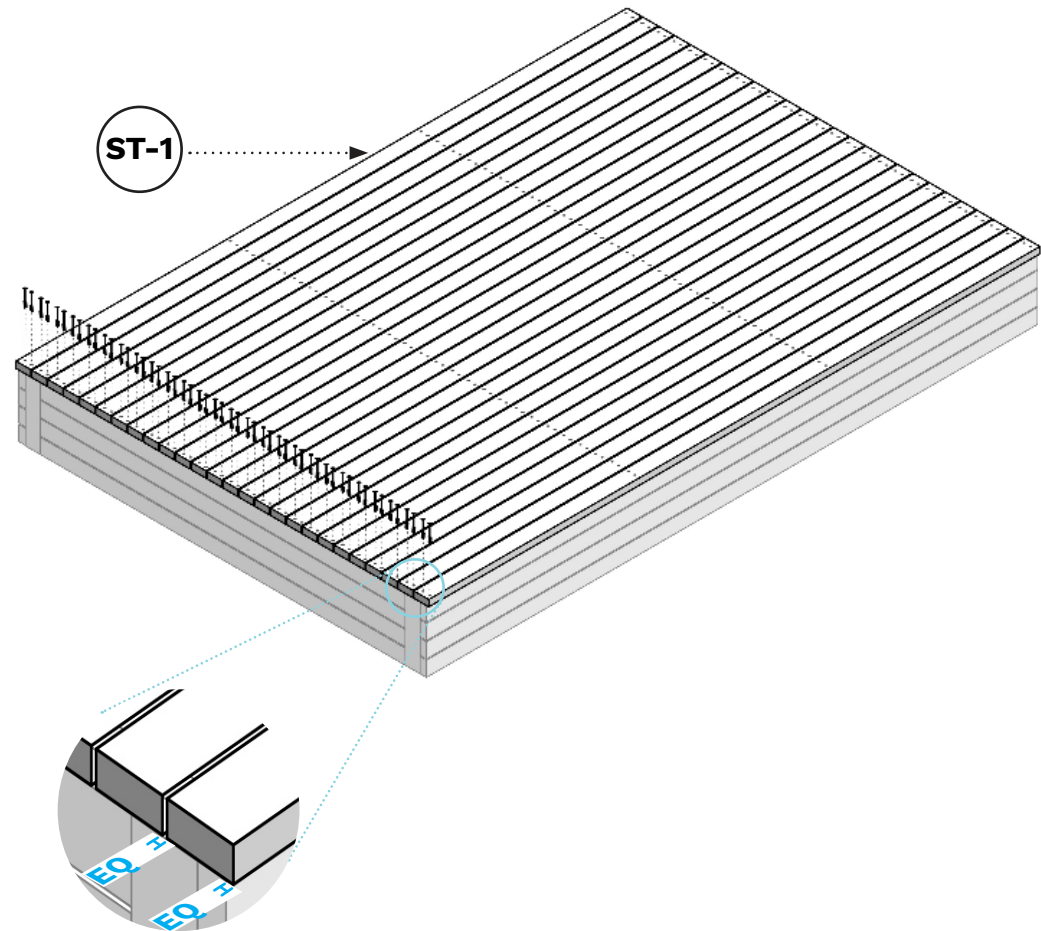
8 STEP

1. PLACE (26) ST-1 PIECES ON TOP OF THE FRAME CREATED IN STEP SEVEN. ALIGNING EDGES AND FLUSH WITH EQUAL SPACING.

TIP: USE YOUR CARPENTERS SQUARE AS A SPACER.

2. SECURE ST-1 LUMBER AT EACH JOIST WITH YOUR 3 HOLE SCREW PATTERN FOR A TOTAL OF (78) 2.5" SELF DRIVING EXTERIOR WOOD SCREWS PER JOIST

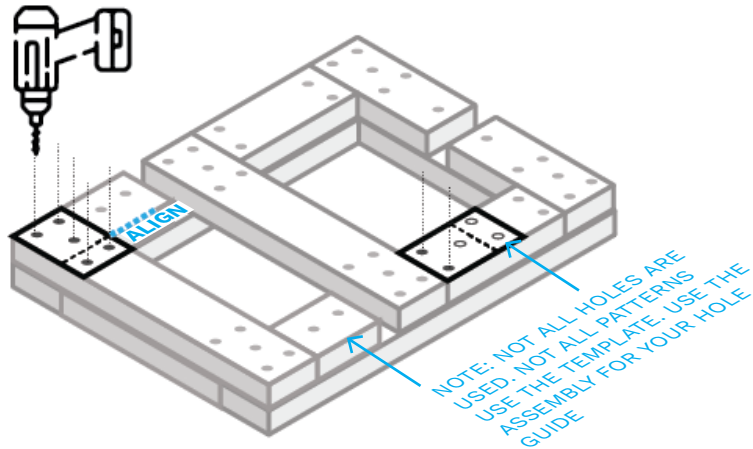
3. LIGHTLY SAND THE ROUGH EDGES OF THE STAGE.



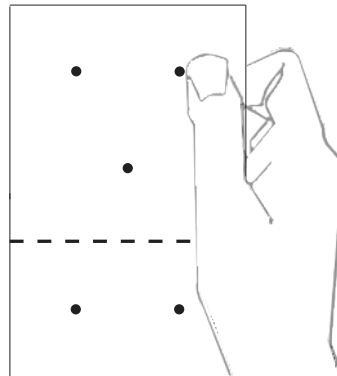


1. CUT OUT PRE-DRILLING HOLE GUIDE ALONG DOTTED LINES

2. WHEN DRILLING, ENSURE THAT YOU PROPERLY **ALIGN THE EDGE OF THE TEMPLATE WITH OUTSIDE EDGE OF THE LUMBER** BEFORE PRE-DRILLING



3. ENSURE ALL HOLES ARE ABOUT A **THUMB IN WIDTH FROM THE EDGE (~1")** EVEN HOLES THAT DON'T USE THIS TEMPLATE



PRE-DRILLING HOLE GUIDE

